(Amendment) Bill, it was able to mount a swift counter-protest response.

In Karnataka, for example, in February 2020, the party's central high command targeted reaching 3,00,000 houses with the BJP's counter-messaging on the CAA. The Karnataka unit state says that, using this structure, it accessed 3,21,000 households and distributed party pamphlets on the issue to each of them within a month.[53] The party's general secretary in Karnataka, N. Ravi Kumar, told me that most of its mobilisation programmes, like the one in favour of CAA, are built around such databases. 'For any abhiyan [campaign] at the national level, there is a call centre for important office-bearers to coordinate,' said Kumar, whose job revolved around coordinating such party work.

He gave me a useful illustration of how this worked in practice. 'If the BJP president has given a call to do some action, like holding marches or reaching out to households, then our office becomes the nodal point in our state. The BJP's organisation secretary, B.L. Santhosh, will first do a video call with state general secretaries in thirty states. Then, we at the state level will do video calls with all district general secretaries and presidents. We use a lot of technology for this. WhatsApp is big for this and video calls. These calls are then followed up by meetings at the ground level, at mandal, shakthi kendra and district level. There are 224 assembly constituencies in Karnataka with about six–seven zila panchayats in each constituency. We will do meetings in each zila panchayat conducted by the mandal padadhikary [office-holder].'[54]

The party's ground-level machinery of booth workers mobilises with very specific action points during elections. In March 2018, Amit Shah held a day-long pre-poll preparatory conclave with BJP's office-bearers, MPs and booth-level presidents in Karnataka at the Royal Orchid in Yelahanka. One of the outcomes of this meeting was a list of sixteen steps the booth workers were asked to follow. They were to implement the following to-do list in order to identify and engage with sixteen categories of people in their booth area:[55]

*Appoint a page pramukh [page head, explained in the next section]